

OPTIONAL HELP

Use one hint at a time.

Return to the records as soon as a hint gives you a next step. The original hint levels and exhibit references remain unchanged in this edition.

If a scene has made you certain about somebody, ask which record supports that certainty. Caring about a person, distrusting them, or finding their explanation plausible is not a substitute for a link in the evidence.

The story can leave a motive complicated while the record answers a factual question. You are allowed to reach a firm identification and still disagree about the person involved.

The following pages retain their original hint folios. Read progressively. Keep the separate sealed solution closed until you have committed your answer.

Hints / first nudge

Read only the question you are working on. The next file pages become more explicit.

Where do I start?

Compare E01's rules with the words used by the petitioners in E03. Does the settlement rank names, men, living generations, or branches?

Whose branch comes first?

Use E02 for Gideon's children and E04-E05 for the family behind a changed surname. Mark the order before you cross out anyone.

Is the old memorandum trustworthy?

E09 distinguishes a copied index from full particulars. Ask what the index actually proves and what it omits.

A person seems to disappear

Search the archive index for records that retain a birth date, parent or employee number across a surname change.

What does the relinquishment do?

Separate the signer's position from the position of a descendant. Read R5 and the exact language of E08.

Can I finish with a name?

Your proof needs identity, descent, survival at the cutoff, and priority. E16 tells you what the inquiry can treat as complete.

Hints / compare these records

Branch order

Frances was born before Matthew. Her marriage changes the surname in her records, not her place among Gideon's children. Within her family, compare the two birth dates in E05.

The apparent death

Compare E10 with E11: father, mother's former surname, birthplace and birth date. The age and name in a death index are not the whole identity.

The later surname

E12 has an original engagement and an amendment. Follow its employee number into E15. Use E13 to verify the mother's remarriage.

The census

E14's zero counts apply to the present marriage. A relationship-to-head label does not undo the parentage in a birth record.

The second and third places

After resolving the elder child's branch, consider Alice. Her personal relinquishment requires another step within her branch before returning to Matthew's family.

Hints / the last step

The child in the index

D-447 belongs to Walter and Jane Bell's child. B-903 belongs to Robert and Edith Bell's child. They are different children.

Identity and survival

The service file joins Ada Bell to Ada Finch; the mother, birth date and continuing employee number support the link. E15 places that employee in the house at the required instant.

Priority

Trace Gideon to Frances, then Robert, then the child in B-903. R4 preserves a dead ancestor's branch. Compare that route with Alice's and Matthew's branches.

The next places

Alice is alive but personally relinquished. Her son retains his place under R5. Once Frances's branch is complete, Matthew's elder child is next.

Write your own cited determination before opening the solution. The solution will explain the complete order and the limits of each record.